Domain and *subdomain*, however, lack precise definitions, which makes them hard to apply. We (the authors) discovered that a much better fit for domain decomposition is the concept of *business capability*, derived from the world of enterprise and business architecture. We believe that domain, subdomain, and business capability can be treated as equivalent concepts, although *business capability* has a more precise definition than *domain* or *subdomain*. We explained the concepts of domain and subdomain first to avoid confusion, because Zhamak Dehghani uses those terms in her data mesh principles.

In figure 4.4, you can see the relationships between domain, subdomain, and business capability. A subdomain is a part of the domain; a domain may contain multiple subdomains. Every subdomain can be further split into more granular subdomains. Finally, each subdomain can be treated as a domain on its own. In summary, depending on changes in granularity of the view, every domain may become a subdomain, and vice versa. Because we believe business capability is an equivalent concept to domain and subdomain, as you can see in figure 4.4, it can be used interchangeably.